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EMC Shielding Design to Meet EMC Requirements/Specifications

Abstract

An electromagnetic compatibility (EMC) shield for providing electromagnetic compatibility of electronic components. The EMC shield includes a first portion, a second portion, and a third portion. The first portion being arranged for attachment to a printed circuit board. The second portion being arranged for attachment to a housing at least partially enclosing the printed circuit board. The first and second portions are arranged at an angle to each other. The third portion connects the first and second portions. The third portion is a bend portion between the first portion and the second portion.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

[0001] This application claims priority to EP 24 161 377 filed Mar. 5, 2024, the entire disclosure of which is incorporated by reference.

FIELD

[0002] The present disclosure generally relates to electromagnetic compatibility (EMC) and other purposes related to flow of electric current, heat transfer, vibration transmission or other mechanical activities.

BACKGROUND

[0003] In general, electric and/or magnetic field generated by electronic component(s) may be required to stay confined within a restricted space surrounding such component(s). Also, such fields may be required not to enter the electronic component(s) from outside. The rationale for the above requirements includes avoiding mutual interference among electronic components/devices/units and/or ensuring compliance with regulatory (or customer) specifications. In general, various measures are known to facilitate the electromagnetic compatibility (EMC), for example, shielding electric and/or magnetic fields. Shielding aims at improving EMC properties for electrical components. It may be generally used with any electrical component having high exposure to and/or high emissions of electromagnetic radiation. Shielding measures include placing electronic components within a shield which is formed from sheet metal. However, the design of such known shields may not meet regulatory (or customer) specifications and/or may not be well suited for interfacing with the printed circuit board (PCB) and/or the housing (or stamping cover, or other mechanical object having characteristics of conducting electric current) of the device/unit comprising the electronic component(s) to be protected.

[0004] The object of the disclosed subject matter is to provide an enhanced EMC shield for providing electromagnetic compatibility of electronic components which at least partially overcomes disadvantages attributable to prior art EMC shields. The disclosed subject matter may also enhance heat transfer between mechanical and electronic elements, and may also enhance vibrations and electrical contact.

[0005] The background description provided here is for the purpose of generally presenting the context of the disclosure. Work of the presently named inventors, to the extent it is described in this background section, as well as aspects of the description that may not otherwise qualify as prior art at the time of filing, are neither expressly nor impliedly admitted as prior art against the present disclosure.

SUMMARY

[0006] The above-mentioned object is realized by an EMC shield according to the present disclosure.

[0007] Particularly, the above-mentioned object is realized by an EMC shield for providing electromagnetic compatibility of electronic components. The EMC shield comprises a first portion being arranged for being attached to a printed circuit board (PCB) and a second portion being arranged for being attached (e.g., directly or indirectly) to a housing at least partially enclosing the PCB. The first and second portions are arranged at an angle to each other which excludes an angle of substantially 0 degree. This means that the first and second portions are not entirely comprised within a single plane. The EMC shield further comprises a third portion connecting the first and second portions which is a bend portion between the first portion and a second portion. Each portion may be formed as one or more walls, a mesh, a foam, or the like. As a result, the first portion may be attached (e.g., soldered, press-fitted, or the like) substantially perpendicular to the PCB and the second portion may be attached at an angle different than perpendicularly to the housing enclosing the PCB. The use of the bend portion may (relative to the use of a straight EMC shield) advantageously compensate manufacturing tolerances, such as the height of the EMC shield, and effectuate advantageous contact (e.g., planar contact, not edge contact; electric and/or

mechanical, and/or thermal contact) between the second portion of the EMC shield and the housing (e.g., a cover of the housing). In addition, the use of the bend portion may advantageously enable spring properties of the EMC shield (e.g., the second portion, and preferably the third portion) which may be advantageous for assembling/closing the housing.

[0008] In an aspect of the present disclosure, the first portion is substantially perpendicular to the second portion. This may advantageously provide a larger area of contact (e.g., electric and/or thermal contact) between the second portion of the EMC shield and the housing.

[0009] In a further aspect of the present disclosure, the third portion has a bending radius of at least 0,5 mm, preferably at least 1,0 mm and more preferably between 1,0 mm and 3,0 mm. As a result, the third portion of the EMC shield may advantageously provide a transition region between the first and second portions. In addition, the second portion (and preferably also the third portion) is arranged such that the second portion has spring properties which may be advantageous for assembling/closing the housing.

[0010] In a further aspect of the present disclosure, the first portion is formed as one or more walls and the second portion is formed as one or more walls. This may advantageously shield electric and/or magnetic fields, and/or provide stiffness of the first and second portions. Preferably the first portion is formed as a plurality of walls forming a prism having inside an opening. As a result, one or more electronic components may be advantageously located within the prism and hence may obtain EMC shielding. Further preferably the prism has a substantially rectangular base. As a result, typical electronic components having rectangular footprint, such as integrated circuits (ICs), processors, or the like, may be advantageously located within the prism. Alternatively, the prism may have a substantially circular base. As a result, electronic components having circular footprint, such as coils, or the like, may be advantageously located within the prism.

[0011] In a further aspect of the present disclosure, the third portion is bent outwards the first portion such that the second portion forms a flange for being attached to the housing. As a result, the opening inside the prism may be advantageously uniform along the height of the EMC shield such that, for example, a thermal conductor (e.g., a pedestal of the housing) may be advantageously located within the prism and to be (thermally) attached to the electronic component located within the EMC shield. In addition, the flange may advantageously establish contact (e.g., planar contact) between the second portion of the EMC shield and the housing (e.g., the cover).

[0012] In a further aspect of the present disclosure, the first portion comprises a plurality of mounting tabs arranged along a first edge. The first edge may be the edge located adjacent to the PCB when the EMC shield is mounted on the PCB. The mounting tabs may advantageously facilitate mounting (e.g., soldering) the EMC shield to the PCB. The shape and dimensions of the mounting tabs may be selected to advantageously distribute strain and avoid cracking (e.g., of the solder). Preferably, the plurality of mounting tabs is arranged equidistantly along the first edge. This may advantageously result in uniform distribution of strain resulting from mounting the EMC shield to the PCB. Further preferably, each mounting tab is substantially rectangular. This may advantageously facilitate manufacturing the EMC shield and soldering it to the PCB.

[0013] In a further aspect of the present disclosure, the second portion (and preferably also the third portion) comprises a plurality of recesses arranged along a second edge. The second edge may be the edge opposite to the first edge (i.e., the edge located adjacent to the PCB when the EMC shield is mounted on the PCB). This may advantageously facilitate bending the third portion, facilitate spring properties of the EMC shield (e.g., the second portion, and preferably also the third portion) and may be advantageous for assembling/closing the housing. The shape and dimensions of the recesses may be selected to advantageously facilitate bending the third portion and may be advantageous for assembling/closing the housing. Preferably the recesses are arranged equidistantly. This may advantageously result in uniform distribution of strain resulting from attaching the second portion of the EMC shield to the housing. Further preferably, each recess is substantially rectangular or U-shaped. This may advantageously facilitate manufacturing the EMC

shield.

[0014] In a further aspect of the present disclosure, each recess has an axis in a plane being substantially parallel to an axis of the prism such that the second portion has the spring properties in a direction substantially parallel to the axis of the prism. This arrangement of the recesses advantageously enables establishing the spring properties in a direction substantially perpendicular to the housing (e.g., the cover).

[0015] In a further aspect of the present disclosure, the EMC shield is formed from stamped and bent sheet metal. As a result, manufacturing of the EMC shield may be advantageously facilitated.

[0016] In a further aspect of the present disclosure, the EMC shield is integrally formed from one piece of stamped and bent sheet metal. As a result, ease of manufacturing and assembling of the EMC shield may be advantageously achieved. The single sheet metal is preferably welded or pressed at least two edges to form a closed polygon. As a result, a form of the EMC shield which is ready to be mounted on the PCB may be advantageously achieved.

[0017] Further particularly, the above-mentioned object is realized by an electronic unit comprising a printed circuit board (PCB), a housing (or another metallic device) at least partially enclosing the PCB, and the above-described EMC shield in which the first portion is attached (e.g., soldered) to the PCB and the second portion is attached (e.g., directly or by using intervening elements) to the housing such that EMC shielding and thermal conductivity are ensured. As a result, the above-described EMC shield may be advantageously applied in the electronic unit.

[0018] In an aspect of the present disclosure, the second portion is attached to the housing via one or more pads made of a material being one or more compressible, thermally conductive, electrically conductive. A compressible material may advantageously compensate manufacturing tolerances and may absorb relative movement between the second portion of the EMC shield and the housing (avoid rattle) caused, for example, by vibrations of the electronic unit. A thermally conductive material may advantageously facilitate heat conduction from the PCB to the housing of the electronic unit. Such pads are often referred to as thermal pads and may comprise metallic particles. An electrically conductive material may advantageously further enhance EMC shielding by providing a conductive path between the PCB and the housing of the electronic unit.

[0019] In a further aspect of the present disclosure, each pad is either glued on the housing or is compressed between a corresponding second portion and the housing with no glue being used. As a result, ease of assembling of the electronic unit comprising the EMC shield may be advantageously achieved.

[0020] In a further aspect of the present disclosure, the second portion is directly attached to the housing. This may advantageously provide function of pressing the PCB by the housing and facilitate heat conduction from the PCB to the housing of the electronic unit.

[0021] In a further aspect of the present disclosure, the electronic unit further comprises an integrated circuit (IC) component mounted on the PCB and the EMC shield surrounds the IC component. As a result, electromagnetic compatibility of the IC component may be advantageously provided. Preferably the housing comprises a pedestal (thermally) attached to the IC component and the pedestal is at least partially located in at least a part of the opening. This may advantageously provide heat conduction from the IC component via the pedestal to the housing (or another mechanical object, e.g., cover) of the electronic unit.

[0022] Further areas of applicability of the present disclosure will become apparent from the detailed description, the claims, and the drawings. The detailed description and specific examples are intended for purposes of illustration only and are not intended to limit the scope of the disclosure.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0023] The present disclosure will become more fully understood from the detailed description and the accompanying drawings.

[0024] FIG. 1 shows a three-dimensional view of an embodiment of an EMC shield;

[0025] FIG. 2 shows a three-dimensional view of an embodiment of a printed circuit board;

[0026] FIG. 3 shows a three-dimensional view of an embodiment of an electronic unit;

[0027] FIG. 4 shows a three-dimensional view of another embodiment of a printed circuit board;

[0028] FIG. 5 shows a three-dimensional view of another embodiment of an electronic unit;

[0029] FIG. 6 shows another three-dimensional view of the other embodiment of an electronic unit.

[0030] In the drawings, reference numbers may be reused to identify similar and/or identical elements.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0031] FIG. 1 shows-in a three-dimensional view-an EMC shield **100** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure. The EMC shield **100** comprises a first portion **102**. The first portion **102** is arranged for being attached to a printed circuit board (PCB) (not shown). The first portion **102** is formed as 4 walls forming a prism having inside an opening **104**. The first portion **102** comprises a plurality of mounting tabs **106** arranged along a first edge **108**. The first edge **108** is located adjacent to the PCB when the EMC shield **100** is mounted on the PCB. Each mounting tab **106** is substantially rectangular with rounded edges. The mounting tabs **106** are arranged substantially equidistantly. The mounting tabs **106** may be arranged to be solderable to the PCB such that the first portion **102** is substantially perpendicular to the PCB.

[0032] The EMC shield **100** further comprises a second portion **110**. The second portion **110** is arranged for being attached to a housing (not shown) in which the PCB is (at least partially) enclosed. The second portion **110** is formed as individual walls, each of which is substantially perpendicular to the first portion **102**. The individual walls forming the second portion **110** are arranged to form a flange for being attached to the housing.

[0033] The EMC shield **100** further comprises a third portion **112**. The third portion **112** is located between the first portion **102** and the second portion **110**, and connects the first portion **102** and the second portion **110**. The third portion **112** is bent outwards the first portion **102** such that the second portion **110** forms the flange. The third portion **112** has a bending radius of approx. 1,5 mm. The second portion **110**, the third portion **112**, and the first portion **102** comprise a plurality of recesses **114**. The recesses **114** are arranged along a second edge **116** and are substantially rectangular with rounded edges.

[0034] The bending of the third portion **112** and the recesses **114** provide spring properties to the second portion **110** and the third portion **112**. More specifically, the spring properties are in a direction which is substantially parallel to the axis of the prism. In general, the spring properties are determined (among others) by the shape and dimensions of the bending of the third portion **112** and of the recesses **114**.

[0035] The EMC shield **100** is formed from a single piece of stamped and bent sheet metal. The single sheet metal is welded at edges **118** to form a closed polygon and consequently a prism. The skilled person recognizes that the EMC shield **100** may also be formed from a plurality of pieces of stamped and bent sheet metal which are then connected together (e.g., welded, pressed, glued, soldered, connected by hard facing, or the like) to form a closed polygon and consequently a prism.

[0036] FIG. 2 shows-in a three-dimensional view-a section of a printed circuit board **200** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure. The printed circuit board **200** comprises a plurality of electronic components **202** including an integrated circuit (IC) component **204** which are mounted thereon. The IC component **204** may be a microprocessor, a microcontroller, or the like. Various techniques to design and manufacture a printed circuit board are generally known to the skilled person.

[0037] Certain amount of electric and/or magnetic field generated by the IC component **204** is required to stay confined within a restricted space surrounding the IC component **204**. Further, only certain amount of electric and/or magnetic field is allowed to enter the IC component **204** from outside. The limits for such electric and/magnetic fields are defined in regulatory (or customer) specifications.

[0038] To facilitate satisfying the above-mentioned limits on electric and/or magnetic field, the printed circuit board **200** comprises the above-described EMC shield **100** (explained in conjunction with FIG. 1). The EMC shield **100** is mounted to the printed circuit board **200** by soldering the mounting taps **106** to the printed circuit board **200** at a plurality of soldering locations **206**.

[0039] FIG. 3 shows—in a three-dimensional view—a section of an electronic unit **300** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure. The electronic unit **300** comprises the printed circuit board **200** (explained in conjunction with FIG. 2), a housing **302** which at least partially encloses the printed circuit board **200**, and the EMC shield **100** (explained in conjunction with FIG. 1). Various techniques to design and manufacture a housing are generally known to the skilled person. The housing **302** is made of die cast aluminum. However, other materials (e.g., magnesium, zinc) are envisaged.

[0040] The EMC shield **100** is directly attached to the housing **302** at a contact location **304**. The second portion **110** of the EMC shield **100** is substantially parallel to a cover of the housing **302** of the electronic unit **300**. The direct contact between the EMC shield **100** and the housing **302** (via the second portion **110** at the contact location **304**) facilitates heat conduction from the printed circuit board **200** to the housing **302**. The direct contact between the EMC shield **100** and the housing **302** of the electronic unit **300** also enhances EMC shielding by providing a conductive path between the printed circuit board **200** and the housing **302**.

[0041] The electronic unit **300** comprises the IC component **204** (explained in conjunction with FIG. 2) located on the printed circuit board **200**. A pedestal **306** (which is an element of the housing **302** intended as a heat conductor) is thermally conductively attached to the top housing of the IC component **204**. The opening **104** within the EMC shield **100** facilitates attaching the pedestal **306** to the IC component **204**.

[0042] FIG. 4 shows—in a three-dimensional view—a section of a printed circuit board **400** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure. Similar as the printed circuit board **200**, also the printed circuit board **400** comprises a plurality of electronic components including an integrated circuit (IC) component **402** mounted thereon. The IC component **402** may be the same as the IC component **204**.

[0043] As at the printed circuit board **200**, the above-described EMC shield is mounted on the printed circuit board **400** to facilitate satisfying specifications for electric and/or magnetic field radiated from the IC component **402** and/or entering the IC component **402** from outside.

[0044] Unlike at the printed circuit board **200**, at the printed circuit board **400**, the EMC shield **100**, is not directly attached to a housing (not shown) in which the printed circuit board **400** is (at least partially) enclosed. Rather, the EMC shield **100** is attached to the housing via a plurality of pads **404**.

[0045] The pads **404** provide multi-fold functionalities: In some aspects, the pads **404** may be compressible. Compressible pads compensate manufacturing tolerances of the printed circuit board **400**, the EMC shield **100**, the housing, or the like. Further, compressible pads absorb relative movement between the second portion **110** of the EMC shield **100** and the housing. In other words, compressible pads facilitate handing rattle caused, for example, by vibrations. In other aspects, the pads may be thermally conductive. Such pads are often referred to as thermal pads and may comprise metallic particles. Thermally conductive pads facilitate heat conduction from the printed circuit board **400** to the housing. In still other aspects, the pads may be electrically conductive. Electrically conductive pads further enhance (relative to the EMC shield **100** taken on its own) EMC shielding by providing a conductive path between the printed circuit board **400** and the

housing. The above-explained multi-fold functionalities of the pads **404** may be advantageously combined with each other.

[0046] Similar as at the printed circuit board **200**, also at the printed circuit board **400**, the EMC shield **100** is mounted to the printed circuit board **400** by soldering the mounting taps to the printed circuit board **400** at a plurality of soldering locations.

[0047] FIG. **5** shows—in a three-dimensional view—a section of an electronic unit **500** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure. The electronic unit **500** comprises the printed circuit board **400** (explained in conjunction with FIG. **4**), a housing **502** which at least partially encloses the printed circuit board **400**, the EMC shield **100** (explained in conjunction with FIG. **1**) and the pads **404** (explained in conjunction with FIG. **4**). The housing **502** is made of die cast aluminum. However, other materials are envisaged.

[0048] The EMC shield **100** is attached to the housing **502** via the pads **404**. The second portion **110** of the EMC shield **100** may be arranged substantially parallel to a cover of the housing **502** or may be slightly angulated. Tolerances with respect to distance and/or angle between the second portion **110** and the housing **502** are compensated by the pads **404**. In addition, in view of the multi-fold functionalities of the pads **404**, the pads **404** may absorb relative movement between the second portion **110** of the EMC shield **100** and the housing **502**, may facilitate heat conduction from the printed circuit board **400** to the housing **502**, and/or may enhance EMC shielding by providing a conductive path between the printed circuit board **400** and the housing **502** of the electronic unit **500**.

[0049] Similar as at the electronic unit **300**, also the electronic unit **500** comprises the IC component **402** located at the printed circuit board **400**. A pedestal **504** (which is an element of the housing **502** intended as a heat conductor) is thermally conductively attached to the top of the housing of the IC component **402**. The opening **104** with the EMC shield facilitates attaching the pedestal **504** to the IC component **402**.

[0050] In some aspects of the present disclosure, the pads **404** are glued on the housing **502** prior to final assembling (closing) the housing **502**. In other aspects, the pads are arranged (e.g., deposited) onto the second portion **110** of the EMC shield **100** prior to final assembling (closing) the housing **502**. In this aspect, upon the assembling, the pads **404** are compressed between the second portion **110** and the housing **502** with no glue (or the like) being used.

[0051] FIG. **6** shows—in a three-dimensional view—another section of the electronic unit **500** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure. The EMC shield **100** is soldered to the printed circuit board **400**. The pads **404** are placed and compressed between the second portion **110** of the EMC shield **100** and the housing **502** of the electronic unit **500** at assembling/closing the housing **502**.

[0052] The term non-transitory computer-readable medium does not encompass transitory electrical or electromagnetic signals propagating through a medium (such as on a carrier wave). Non-limiting examples of a non-transitory computer-readable medium are nonvolatile memory circuits (such as a flash memory circuit, an erasable programmable read-only memory circuit, or a mask read-only memory circuit), volatile memory circuits (such as a static random access memory circuit or a dynamic random access memory circuit), magnetic storage media (such as an analog or digital magnetic tape or a hard disk drive), and optical storage media (such as a CD, a DVD, or a Blu-ray Disc).

[0053] The term “set” generally means a grouping of one or more elements. The elements of a set do not necessarily need to have any characteristics in common or otherwise belong together. The phrase “at least one of A, B, and C” should be construed to mean a logical (A OR B OR C), using a non-exclusive logical OR, and should not be construed to mean “at least one of A, at least one of B, and at least one of C.” The phrase “at least one of A, B, or C” should be construed to mean a logical (A OR B OR C), using a non-exclusive logical OR.

Claims

1. An electromagnetic compatibility (EMC) shield for providing electromagnetic compatibility of electronic components, the EMC shield comprising: a first portion being arranged for attachment to a printed circuit board; a second portion being arranged for attachment to a housing at least partially enclosing the printed circuit board, wherein the first and second portions are arranged at an angle to each other; and a third portion connecting the first and second portions, wherein the third portion is a bend portion between the first portion and the second portion.
2. The EMC shield of claim 1 wherein the first portion is substantially perpendicular to the second portion.
3. The EMC shield of claim 1 wherein: the third portion has a bending radius of at least 0.5 mm, and the second portion and the third portion are arranged such that the second portion has spring properties.
4. The EMC shield of claim 1 wherein: the third portion has a bending radius of at least 1.0 mm, and the second portion and the third portion are arranged such that the second portion has spring properties.
5. The EMC shield of claim 1 wherein: the third portion has a bending radius between 1.0 mm and 3.0 mm, and the second portion and the third portion are arranged such that the second portion has spring properties.
6. The EMC shield of claim 1 wherein: the first portion is formed as one or more walls, and the second portion is formed as one or more walls.
7. The EMC shield of claim 1 wherein: the first portion is formed as a plurality of walls forming a prism having an opening, and the prism has a substantially rectangular base or a substantially circular base.
8. The EMC shield of claim 7 wherein the third portion is bent outwards from the first portion such that the second portion forms a flange arranged for being attached to the housing.
9. The EMC shield of claim 7 wherein: the first portion includes a plurality of mounting tabs arranged along a first edge, the plurality of mounting tabs is arranged equidistantly, and each mounting tab is substantially rectangular.
10. The EMC shield of claim 9 wherein: the second portion and the third portion include a plurality of recesses arranged along a second edge, the recesses are arranged equidistantly, and each recess is substantially rectangular or U-shaped.
11. The EMC shield of claim 10 wherein each recess has an axis in a plane being substantially parallel to an axis of the prism such that the second portion has spring properties in a direction substantially parallel to the axis of the prism.
12. The EMC shield of claim 1 wherein the EMC shield is formed from stamped and bent sheet metal.
13. The EMC shield of claim 12 wherein the EMC shield is integrally formed from one piece of stamped and bent sheet metal and the sheet metal is welded or pressed at at least two edges to form a closed polygon.
14. An electronic unit comprising: the printed circuit board; the housing at least partially enclosing the printed circuit board; and the EMC shield of claim 1, wherein the first portion is attached to the printed circuit board, and wherein the second portion is attached to the housing.
15. The electronic unit of claim 14 wherein the second portion is attached to the housing via one or more pads made of a material being one or more of compressible, thermally conductive, or electrically conductive.
16. The electronic unit of claim 15 wherein each pad is either glued on the housing or is compressed between a corresponding second portion and the housing with no glue being used.
17. The electronic unit of claim 14 wherein the second portion is directly attached to the housing.

18. The electronic unit of claim 14 further comprising an integrated circuit component mounted on the printed circuit board, wherein: the EMC shield surrounds the integrated circuit component, the housing includes a pedestal attached to the integrated circuit component, and the pedestal is at least partially located in at least a part of an opening of the first portion.
